

# **PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION AND AWARENESS REPORT**

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## **1. Objective**

To identify phishing emails by analyzing suspicious characteristics and to create awareness about common phishing techniques and prevention methods.

## **2. Introduction**

Phishing is a cyberattack where attackers impersonate trusted organizations to steal sensitive information such as passwords, banking details, and personal data through deceptive emails, links, or attachments.

## **3. Sample Email Analysis**

The email claims that the user's account will be locked and urges immediate verification through a suspicious link.

Subject: Urgent: Your Account Will Be Locked

Sender: [security@account-support-alert.com](mailto:security@account-support-alert.com)

## **4. Phishing Indicators**

- A. Generic Greeting – Uses "Dear User" instead of the recipient's name.
- B. Urgency – Creates panic by warning of account lock within 24 hours.
- C. Suspicious URL – Contains a non-official and suspicious website link.
- D. Sensitive Information Request – Attempts to collect account details.

## 5. Risk Classification

Risk Level: **HIGH**

The email contains multiple phishing indicators including urgency, suspicious links, generic greetings, and fear-based language.

Users who interact with the email may expose sensitive information such as login credentials or personal data. If the malicious link is clicked, it could lead to account compromise, financial loss, or identity theft.

## 6. Prevention Guidelines

- Verify sender email addresses.
- Check URLs before clicking.
- Avoid suspicious attachments.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication.
- Report phishing emails.
- Keep software and antivirus programs updated.
- Do not share passwords or OTPs through email.
- Verify suspicious requests through official communication channels.

## 6. Conclusion

The analyzed email demonstrates common phishing techniques used by cybercriminals to deceive users. Awareness and careful verification of emails can significantly reduce the risk of falling victim to phishing attacks. Regular cybersecurity training helps users identify and avoid such threats.

## 7. References

- Cybersecurity awareness resources
- Email security best practices
- Phishing awareness guidelines